

See discussions, stats, and author profiles for this publication at: <https://www.researchgate.net/publication/355311072>

UNDERSTANDING THE BALOCHISTAN CONUNDRUM

Chapter · September 2020

DOI: 10.2307/j.ctv20p00x9.22

CITATIONS

7

READS

263

1 author:



Rafiullah Kakar

Planning Commission Pakistan

17 PUBLICATIONS 61 CITATIONS

SEE PROFILE

Chapter Eighteen

UNDERSTANDING THE BALOCHISTAN CONUNDRUM

Rafiullah Kakar

Background

Balochistan is the largest and most ethnolinguistically diverse province of Pakistan but the smallest in terms of population. Baloch (including Brahuis) and Pashtuns respectively are the biggest ethnic groups, accounting for nearly 90 per cent of the total population of the province. Bordering Iran and Afghanistan, Balochistan occupies a central strategic place at the juncture of world's three important regions – Central Asia, South Asia and the Middle East. The province is rich in gas, copper, gold and other natural resources. Owing to its important strategic location and rich resources, Balochistan has often remained a centre of attention for national, regional and international actors. Over the past decade, the development of a deep seaport at Gwadar and the launching of various trans-state pipeline projects to meet Islamabad's energy needs have further enhanced Balochistan's economic and strategic importance. More recently, the establishment of the China Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) has placed Balochistan at the centre stage of regional geo-economics and geopolitics.¹

Despite being rich in natural resources and having a large coastline, the province has experienced weak economic growth relative to other provinces and performs poorly on nearly all the social and human development indicators. With nearly three out of every four people living in acute poverty, Balochistan has the highest rate of multidimensional poverty among all the provinces in Pakistan.² Similarly, it has the lowest literacy rate, lowest enrolment rates, highest gender gap, and lowest access and poorest learning outcomes.³ Over one million (39 per cent) children remain out of school.⁴ Furthermore, it features highest rates of maternal and infant mortality; for instance, every 785 out of a hundred thousand mothers lose their lives during pregnancy, whereas in the rest of the country this figure stands at 272.⁵

Understanding the Conflict Landscape in Balochistan

Balochistan has remained a hotbed of ethnic conflict since the creation of Pakistan. The province has seen four insurgencies (1948, 1962–69, 1973–77, 2006–present) with the latest wave of violence being the most protracted one. The current insurgency began after the killing of prominent Baloch leader Nawab Akbar Bugti in a security operation in 2006. While Bugti was willing to hold dialogue with the federal government,

his successors – who are predominantly educated young people from middle-class backgrounds – spurn coexistence within the federation of Pakistan.

Over the past decade, conflict landscape in the restive province has become very complex with the rise of sectarian and religious conflicts. Concentrated mainly in the Pashtun-dominated northern region, the roots of religious militancy in the province can be traced back to the US invasion of Afghanistan when a large number of fleeing Taliban fighters and leaders took refuge in the province. These sanctuaries subsequently enabled Taliban to regroup and wage war against the US-led coalition forces and the Afghan government. Northern Balochistan became home to what came to be known as the Quetta Shura.⁶ The Americans have accused it of being the most active enemy group in southern Afghanistan. Besides being home to Taliban who are fighting in Afghanistan, Balochistan has also witnessed increasing footprint of Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP) and Islamic State of Iraq and Syria (ISIS).⁷ These groups have targeted security forces and law enforcement agencies, shrines, lawyers and universities.

Other than these, Balochistan has also seen a surge in sectarian attacks over the past decade. The roughly half million Hazaras living in Balochistan have been under attack since 2001, and these attacks have intensified since 2008: according to official figures, more than 3,000 members of the Hazara community have been killed since 2011 and more than 70,000 have fled, many of them undertaking perilous journeys to seek refuge in Australia.⁸

Systemic Drivers of the Balochistan Conflict

While the roots of the Baloch ethnic conflict can be traced back to the colonial period and the subsequent forced annexation of the Kalat State and its principalities to Pakistan, a number of complex and interconnected political and economic factors have fuelled and sustained the conflict since the creation of Pakistan. Here are some of the most important systemic drivers of the conflict:

1. Authoritarianism

Pakistan has remained under direct military rule for more than half of its life history. Military regimes not only shut the doors of political participation for the Baloch people but also used force and hard measures such as enforced disappearances and extrajudicial killings to deal with the Baloch ethnic issue. Even during brief periods when democracy returned, the military has exercised considerable political influence, especially in Balochistan.⁹

The real problem in the military's handling of Balochistan lies in the paranoid mindset underpinning its approach.¹⁰ The military has traditionally viewed Balochistan through a very narrow security prism. They regard relatively assertive and independent voices from the province as “traitors” or “foreign agents” and view Baloch insurgency as a “conspiracy” launched by hostile regional and extra-regional players to destabilise and disintegrate Pakistan. This thinking has led the military to use a range of interventionist measures including use of force, political exclusion and co-optation.¹¹ As mentioned

above, four military operations have been carried out in Balochistan since 1947, and all of them managed to exacerbate the situation.¹²

While the military's use of force is well known, its role in manoeuvring and engineering the political fabric of the province has gone relatively unnoticed.¹³ Over the years, the military has tried to suppress and counteract genuine and assertive voices and replace them with more pliant and amenable voices. An entire cadre of artificial leadership has been created.¹⁴ Led by tribal *sardars*,¹⁵ this group of elites is not accountable to the electorate and relies on deeply entrenched patron-client networks and extra-constitutional means to get re-elected. They frequently switch political loyalties and remain part of almost every government.¹⁶ Over the years, the so-called country-wide parties like the Pakistan Muslim League-Nawaz (PML-N), Pakistan Muslim League-Quaid-e-Azam (PML-Q) and Pakistan Peoples Party (PPP) have remained home to this group of ever-green politicians.

In short, periods of direct and indirect military rule along with political exclusion, repression and political engineering have created a deep sense of alienation and frustration among the people of Balochistan. It has not only impeded the growth and strengthening of political parties but has also ended up creating serious crises of legitimacy and governance.

2. Centralisation of Powers

The over-centralisation of powers and suppression of regional identities by the ruling elites of Pakistan is one of the most significant systemic drivers of the Baloch ethnic conflict.¹⁷ Federalism in Pakistan has faced the perennial problem of demographic preponderance of one province over others: first East Pakistan and then, 1971 onwards, the Punjab.¹⁸ The constitutions of 1956 and 1962 provided for a centralised federal system based on equal representation in parliament of the two wings of the state. Baloch and Pashtuns resisted this centralisation of power¹⁹ and laid the foundation of National Awami Party (NAP) to advocate for provincial autonomy.²⁰

The 1973 constitution introduced a proper federal system by creating a bicameral legislature, recognising provincial languages, introducing a quota system for provinces in central bureaucracy and establishing the Council of Common Interests (CCI) – a forum for the resolution of disputes between the centre and the federating units and the protection of political rights of the latter. But even though the federal model proposed by the 1973 constitution was better than the previous ones, it established a strong centre and granted little autonomy to the provinces. Baloch and Pashtun leadership reluctantly accepted it on assurances by Zulfikar Ali Bhutto that the vague concurrent list would be reviewed after a decade.²¹

However, the dissolution of NAP government in Balochistan, the ensuing armed rebellion and counter-insurgency military operation squandered whatever little gains had been made. Bhutto's antagonistic policies and actions radicalised the Baloch national movement and alienated those who advocated non-violent parliamentary struggle for the achievement of national rights.²² These differences over the efficacy of parliamentary politics were one of the reasons why Baloch and Pashtuns could not unite again to

carry out joint struggle the way they did in the 1960s. Moreover, the Baloch national movement also broke into moderate and hard-line factions – a division that persists up to the present day. Although several interethnic political alliances were formed subsequently, none of them survived the test of time. Since the 1980s, the Baloch, Pashtun and Sindhi nationalists have invoked the 1940 resolution to demand maximum autonomy for provinces within the framework of a confederation.

3. Majoritarian Federal Design

With Punjab accounting for 56 per cent of the country's total population, the centralisation of power only resulted in the "Punjabisation" of Pakistan.²³ For example, the Punjab had more seats in the National Assembly than all of the other three provinces combined. The upper house, where all provinces had equal representation, had the potential to balance out Punjab's majoritarian influence, but this was prevented by the fact that the upper house (Senate) had lesser powers as compared to the lower house (National Assembly). The Senate had no control over money bills and little influence over matters affecting the federation such as the appointment of high-level executives. Moreover, the indirect election method for the upper house made Senate elections prone to vote-buying practices, especially in Balochistan. In short, Senate has not been effective in guarding against the overbearing power of the Punjab-dominated National Assembly.

The CCI provided another forum that smaller provinces could have used to counter the political domination of Punjab; the council, however, remained a weak body until the introduction of the 18th amendment.²⁴ The ineffectiveness of the Senate and the council and under-representation of Balochistan in federal executive institutions, such as the bureaucracy and the military, have severely constrained the ability of Balochistan to protect and promote its interests at the federal level. Furthermore, the minimal authority of the Senate vis-à-vis the National Assembly, combined with the fact of Balochistan's small population, meant that the province remained the least attractive political constituency for political parties seeking power at the federal level.²⁵ Pakistan's federal system offers political parties no incentives to care about Balochistan. From the perspective of political parties, Balochistan offers the lowest return on investment in electoral terms. This primarily explains why successive governments in Islamabad, regardless of which party is in power, have tended to remain indifferent towards Balochistan. This apathy has been evident in the discriminatory economic and development policies regarding Balochistan of nearly all the governments in Islamabad. In addition, this lack of interest of statewide political parties in Balochistan not only kept it at the margins of Islamabad's economic and political calculus but also translated into reduced political competition, which is one of the essential ingredients of a vibrant democracy.

4. Economic Grievances and Control over Natural Resources

Unfair distribution of resources and exploitation of the natural resources of the province has long remained a bone of contention between Islamabad and the people of

Balochistan. The Baloch blame Islamabad for exploiting the mineral resources and strategic location of the province.

- a) Natural gas was first discovered at Sui in Dera Bugti in 1952. Since then, Balochistan has remained the major supplier of natural gas to the country, with the absolute quantity of extracted gas rising from 1,535 Million MCF in 1955 to peak value at 387,368 Million MCF in 2001.²⁶ While the absolute quantum of extracted gas from Sui has increased, Balochistan's average share in the total national output has been declining consistently due to discoveries in other provinces; its share has fallen from 91 per cent during 1955–69 to approximately 17 per cent in 2015.²⁷ Despite remaining the largest provider of gas to the national economy for years, Balochistan did not have any gas supply until 1982. After nearly seven decades, Balochistan's share in the national gas consumption (domestic purposes) remains at a mere 4 per cent.²⁸

The province has received a raw deal not only in terms of consumption but also the pricing of its natural gas and the associated excise duty. Over the years, the provision of subsidy on gas has benefitted consuming provinces at the expense of the producing provinces. Between 1955 and 2014, the total gas subsidy has equalled Rs. 21.7 trillion (at the constant price of 2014). With its share equalling Rs. 7.69 trillion (35 per cent), Balochistan has borne the major share of this burden.²⁹ Moreover, the fixed-rate basis (as opposed to percentage-of-price basis) of excise duty, levied by the federal government, has led to a loss of revenues for gas producing provinces. Consequently, Balochistan has lost at the expense of gas consuming provinces like the Punjab and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.

- b) The multibillion-dollar Saindak copper-gold project blister produces copper from the indigenous ore found in the area. The project operation was leased out to the Metallurgical Corporation of China (MCC) – a state-owned entity of China – for 10 years beginning in October 2002. As per the lease agreement, 50 per cent of the revenues went to the MCC, 48 per cent to the government of Pakistan and only 2 per cent went to the government of Balochistan.³⁰ The Aghaz-e-Haqooq-e-Balochistan package envisaged the transfer of the project ownership to the Balochistan government after the completion of its lease term in 2012. But the federal government refused to transfer the ownership of the project to Balochistan, claiming outstanding dues of Rs. 27 billion that it had invested in the project.³¹ The federal government made this demand despite earning \$ 220 million profit from the project in addition to taxes and rent between 2002 and 2012. In contrast, the government of Balochistan had received only \$ 39 million in royalties during the same period.³²

Instead of transferring ownership of the project to Balochistan, the federal government extended the project lease twice for five years in 2012 and 2017 despite requests by the provincial government to take over the project.³³ Currently, the MCC gets 50 per cent share in the profit earned from the project, federal government gets 20 per

cent and Balochistan government takes 30 per cent of the profits.³⁴ Besides, there are complaints about excessive mining; for example, the south ore body, which had a life-span of 19 years, has been exhausted in 15 years. Moreover, there is no monitoring mechanism to check and evaluate the production from Saindak. The Chinese have not yet established a refinery in Pakistan to process the gold and copper ores.

- c) Baloch people also have serious reservations regarding the development of Gwadar port; they consider their coastal and marine resources a part of their natural wealth. When the federal government in 2001 announced the development of Gwadar port, the Baloch nationalist leadership opposed the plan and voiced their concerns, a stalemate that culminated in the killing of Baloch leader Nawab Akbar Bugti in 2006. These tensions have resurfaced with the development of Gwadar port under the multibillion-dollar CPEC.

While the federal government is hopeful that the economic activity created by CPEC will benefit the local people and weaken support for separatism, locals do not share the government's optimism. Recent media reports show that Balochistan has only a meagre share in investments under the umbrella of CPEC.³⁵ Furthermore, the tiny investments committed for Balochistan under CPEC have not arrived either. Besides, road projects in Balochistan that are supposed to be completed by 2020 have seen no progress whatsoever as of December 2018.³⁶ Politicians from across the political spectrum have raised concerns about the province's low share in CPEC-related investments.³⁷

The Baloch want control over the revenue and management of Gwadar port.³⁸ In addition to being concerned about CPEC's economic aspects, the Baloch people also have grievances about its political and strategic aspects. Baloch nationalists maintain that such developmental projects have historically "increased the oppression and isolation of the Baloch rather than providing them socio-economic development and integration".³⁹ The people fear that the influx of skilled human labour will alter the demographic balance of Balochistan.

- d) Balochistan has traditionally raised concerns about unfair distribution of resources and has remained the biggest victim of the population-based criterion for resource distribution.

The passage of the 7th National Finance Commission (NFC) Award in 2009 addressed the concerns of Balochistan and other provinces to a great extent. The new formula assigned weightage to factors other than population such as poverty, revenue generation, revenue collection and area. Balochistan was one of the biggest beneficiaries of the 7th NFC Award; its share in the provincial pool jumped from 5 per cent to 9.09 per cent.⁴⁰ Besides, the 7th NFC Award also revised the formula for the computation of gas development surcharge (GDS) and provided for the retroactive payment of GDS arrears to Balochistan on the basis of the new formula. Lastly, the Award accepted provincial rights over revenue from General Sales Tax (GST) on services.⁴¹

5. *Fragmented Polity*

Politics in Balochistan is characterised by a high degree of fragmentation and polarisation with adverse consequences for social cohesion, governance and service delivery. The key sources of this fragmentation are ethnic heterogeneity and tribalism. The politics of the province has been marred with Pashtun-Baloch divide since the creation of the province in 1970.⁴² In the last days of the Ayub regime, there was a political debate over the form of federation and the basis of new provinces. In Balochistan, this debate was largely focused on whether Pashtun areas should be made a separate province or merged with erstwhile North-West Frontier Province (NWFP) or former Baloch princely states.⁴³ The way the boundaries of Balochistan were drawn disregarded the wishes of a significant section of Pashtuns and Baloch of the province. Pashtuns had cultural affinity and geographical contiguity with the people of the then-NWFP. Moreover, they had remained a majority in the colonial-era administrative unit of British Balochistan.⁴⁴ Therefore, when the Quetta division (former British Balochistan) was merged with the Kalat division (former Kalat State and its principalities) in 1970 to create the new Balochistan province, it resulted in resentment among Pashtuns who got relegated to a minority status overnight. Pashtun nationalists, represented by the Pashtunkhwa Milli Awami Party (PkMAP), have since then demanded a separate province to be carved out of the former British Balochistan or equal power share within existing territorial arrangements.⁴⁵

More than 40 years after the current territorial arrangement was implemented, political differences between the two groups have only sharpened. The situation has been exacerbated by the influx of large number of Afghan refugees into Balochistan who have changed the demographic balance in favour of the Pashtuns. While the Baloch nationalists are staunchly opposed to the presence of Afghan refugees in the province, Pashtun nationalists maintain that the Afghan Pashtuns have shifted location within their own homeland and are, therefore, welcome to stay in the province until the restoration of peace in Afghanistan.

In addition to ethnic diversity, the tribal mode of social organisation in most parts of the province has also contributed to political fragmentation and polarisation. Balochistan has a comprehensive tribal system characterised by a clear leadership structure and lineage patterns, strong bonds of affiliation and well-defined dispute resolution mechanisms.⁴⁶ Tribal networks serve as the avenues for political mobilisation and collective action. But this tribal and ethnic fragmentation has encouraged provision of public services through patronage networks and prevented the emergence of inclusive political parties and stable coalitions among ethnic elites. Statewide parties do not have any meaningful organisational presence in the province, and regional parties are mostly divided along ethnic lines. As a result, coalition politics with its accompanying constraints has become a structural reality of Balochistan, resulting in the formation of weak governments. Moreover, the provincial bureaucracy is also infested with ethnic divide. Public servants often receive protection from respective ethnic elites and, therefore, have little incentive to perform their duties in an impartial and objective manner. The cumulative effect of this divide is that decisions regarding development priorities, resource allocation and administrative

postings are often subjected to ethnic considerations, creating serious issues of inefficiency and mismanagement of resources.

18th Amendment and the Politics of Balochistan

The 18th amendment passed in April 2010 is widely regarded as the most important constitutional development after the passage of the 1973 constitution. The amendment aimed to restore the 1973 constitution to its original shape and intent and remove distortions introduced by military dictators.

The 18th amendment, among others, addressed some of the long-standing demands of smaller provinces. From the perspective of the federation and centre-province relations, the devolution of powers to the provinces through the abolition of concurrent list, reinvigoration of the CCI and provision of constitutional protection to the 7th NFC Award were arguably the most important features of the amendment. Some of the changes that particularly affected Balochistan are as follows:

1. The 18th amendment abolished the concurrent list. Most of the subjects in this list were transferred to provinces, giving them full control over social sectors.
2. The CCI was reinvigorated and its membership was revised in favour of the provinces.
3. Another critical contribution of the amendment was that it made the vertical resource distribution formula agreed upon in the 7th NFC Award irreversible.
4. The amendment gave provinces 50 per cent ownership of gas and oil resources within their territorial boundaries. Despite this, however, the Government of Balochistan has not received ownership of its resources owing to differences over interpretation of the concerned article of the constitution.

Even though the 18th amendment was summarily rejected by Baloch hardliners and separatists as “too little too late”, moderate Baloch and Pashtun nationalists welcomed it and maintained that it marked the culmination of years of struggle and sacrifices. Since its passage, the 18th amendment has affected the politics of Balochistan in profound and diverse ways.

First, the devolution of powers has strengthened centripetal forces in the provinces and stymied the growth of separatist tendencies and extreme nationalism. Post-18th amendment Balochistan witnessed an improvement in levels of political participation: all major Baloch and Pashtun ethnonationalist parties that had boycotted the 2008 general elections re-entered the electoral fold in the 2013 general elections. While there were multiple factors that shaped this decision, the devolution of powers combined with the relative democratic consolidation in the country served as great pull factors.⁴⁷ Compared to previous three general elections, the 2013 elections saw the highest voter turnout in Balochistan.⁴⁸ Subsequently, the active participation of ethnonationalists in parliamentary politics at the provincial level conferred much-needed legitimacy on the government and weakened centrifugal forces in the province.

Second, by making provinces more attractive and lucrative centres of power and political contestation, the 18th amendment increased political competition at the regional

level, especially in provinces. Balochistan saw a considerable rise in political competition. Transfer of powers made ethno-regional parties more relevant and encouraged new regional contenders for power to take part in politics. On account of their strong organisational structure and presence at the grassroots level and support among the educated middle class, ethno-regional parties partially succeeded in bringing the government closer to the people, enhancing its legitimacy and widening access to power of previously deprived groups. Moreover, enhanced political competition also compelled these parties to take the politics of service delivery more seriously. Notwithstanding these advantages, ethno-regional parties also faced serious capacity issues.⁴⁹ They lacked the technical expertise, governance experience and human and financial resources that state-wide parties had access to. As a result, their ability to bring about drastic improvement in governance and service delivery was severely constrained.

Some quarters are concerned that devolution has promoted greater regionalisation of politics and weakened national harmony.⁵⁰ As explained above, there is evidence that devolution has strengthened centripetal forces in Balochistan. Yes, it has strengthened ethno-regional parties but this has not necessarily translated into a weakening of the federation. Instead, the rise in protest events along ethno-regional lines indicates the willingness of smaller ethnic groups to integrate in the federation and use non-violent parliamentary means to achieve their goals. Their protests have acted as a stabilising and integrating force rather than a disintegrating one; having said that, it cannot be denied that this devolution has incentivised statewide political parties like PML-N and PPP to increasingly think in terms of narrow regional objectives. However, it can be argued that these parties were hardly “federal” or “national” parties to begin with. PPP, which had traditionally catered to the interests of smaller provinces, had already lost its ideological charm and support outside rural Sindh by the time the 18th amendment was passed. PML-N never cultivated meaningful support outside Punjab. Devolution of powers only exposed their pretence of being “federal” or “national” parties. PML-N, PPP and PML-Q have ruled Balochistan for approximately 17 years between 1970 and 2017 whereas ethno-regional parties have ruled for only six years during the same period.⁵¹ Despite having ruled the province multiple times, these statewide parties have the poorest organisational strength and support base in the province. Their membership is weak and grassroots presence is almost non-existent. Instead of representing the aggregate interest of the public, these parties are widely believed to advance the interests of the military-dominated state apparatus.

To sum up the discussion, the 18th amendment seems to have had a pacifying impact on the conflict in Balochistan. However, it was not sufficient to resolve the conflict in Balochistan. Of the various systematic drivers of the Balochistan conflict identified in the beginning of this essay, the amendment addressed only one driver, namely, centralised federation. All other issues persist.

The Way Forward

- Political reconciliation must precede development initiatives and economic reforms. Repression and development cannot go hand in hand. The state must

immediately initiate dialogue with Baloch insurgents and address the issues of enforced disappearances and abuse at check posts.

- The continuity and consolidation of democracy and establishment of civilian supremacy is indispensable for amicably resolving the Balochistan conundrum. Security agencies operating in the province need to be brought under civilian control. Democratic consolidation will go a long way towards restoring credibility and legitimacy of the government and strengthening federalism.⁵²
- The federal design needs to be altered in a way that enables smaller provinces like Balochistan to block legislations that may harm them and incentivises national-level parties to take serious interest in Balochistan. The most effective way to achieve this is through Senate reforms. Senate must be given powers equal to that of the National Assembly in both financial and non-financial matters including money bills, high-level executive appointments, ratification of treaties and other matters affecting the federation.⁵³ Moreover, the current indirect Senate elections should be replaced by direct elections of senators by the people of each province through a system of proportional representation.
- The issue of creation of new provinces needs to be addressed, and the cumbersome process for the creation of new provinces should be made simpler. Although academia remains divided on the merits of ethno-federalism, it is widely considered to be better than alternatives in ethnically divided societies. Moreover, the boundaries of existing Balochistan should be redrawn along ethno-national lines; Pashtun areas can be separated to form a separate province.
- Baloch concerns regarding control over their natural resources must be addressed. Jobs should be given to the local population, and policies should be devised to appropriate reasonable amounts of money earned from the projects for the infrastructural and social development of Balochistan.
- Steps should be taken for building and improving the capacity of provinces. Both the civil bureaucracy and political parties of Balochistan lack the capacity to effectively and efficiently exercise powers devolved by the 18th amendment. Consequently, the province's capacity to deliver core services remains limited. Federal government and international donor agencies need to play a role in building the capacity of the province. Moreover, political parties need to augment their technical capacity by recruiting professionals and technical people in its cadres.
- Effective and efficient utilisation of the funds allocated for public sector development programmes is vital for the progress and development of the province. Currently, the development funds are spent based on political expediency rather than the needs of the people.⁵⁴ A large amount of funds is spent on small projects like tube well, solar plate, water ponds, and so on, even though these projects contribute hardly to the development of the province. A provincial planning and development board comprising technical experts in areas of health, education, agriculture and rural development must be constituted to reduce the control of Members of Provincial Assembly (MPAs) over development expenditures.

Notes

- 1 Zofeen Ebrahim, "China's New Silk Road: What's in It for Pakistan?" *Dawn*, 20 April 2015. <http://www.dawn.com/news/1177116>.
- 2 S. Rana, "40% Pakistanis Live in Poverty." *Express Tribune*, 21 June 2016.
- 3 Alif Ailaan, *2013–2018 Five Years of Education Reforms in Balochistan. Wins, Losses and Challenges for 2018–2023* (Islamabad: Alif Ailaan, 2018), 3.
- 4 Ibid.
- 5 Syed Ali Shah, "Maternal and Child Mortality Rate Remains High in Balochistan." *Dawn*, 5 March 2014.
- 6 Abubakar Siddique, "The Quetta Shura: Understanding the Afghan Taliban's Leadership." *Terrorism Monitor* 12 (2014): 4.
- 7 Pakistan Institute for Peace Studies (PIPS), *Pakistan Security Report 2017*. Vol. 10 (January–June 2018), 1
- 8 Jamal Shahid, "More Than 3,000 Hazaras Killed since Sept 11, 2011." *Dawn*, 24 May 2018.
- 9 "Balochistan Govt Tells SC It Has No Control over FC." *Express Tribune*, 31 January 2014.
- 10 Personal Interview, Dr Ayesha Siddiqua (Academic and Political Analyst), 15 May 2015.
- 11 Shah Meer Baloch, "The More You Get Hurt, the More You Scream." *Herald*, 21 June 2018.
- 12 Shah Meer Baloch, "The Long Insurgency." *Dawn*, 31 December 2017.
- 13 Ali Arqam, "The Political Engineers of Balochistan." *Newsline Magazine*, April 2018.
- 14 Personal Communication, Mehmood Khan Achakzai (Chairman PkMAP), 11 April 2015.
- 15 A Persian word denoting a chief or leader of a tribe.
- 16 Adnan Amir, "Rise of the BAP: A New Trend or Political Engineering in Balochistan." *Asia Times*, 6 April 2018. And Sardar Akhtar Mengal Tweet (@sakhartarmengal), "Once again 2013 election scenario is taking place. Our workers are being threatened and harassed to resign from the party by Khalai Makhlooq and forced to join a party that just came into existence by their blessings." Twitter, 28 June 2018.
- 17 Christophe Jaffrelot, "Interpreting Ethnic Movements in Pakistan." *Pakistan Development Review* 37, no. 4 (1998): 153–79.
- 18 Mohammad Waseem, "Pakistan: A Majority-Constraining Federalism." *India Quarterly* 67, no. 3 (2013): 216.
- 19 From Balochistan, "Wror Pashtun" and "Ustaman Gul" played a key role in laying the foundation of NAP.
- 20 Craig Baxter, "Constitution Making: The Development of Federalism in Pakistan." *Asian Survey* 14, no. 12 (1974): 1078.
- 21 Personal Interview, Hasil Bizenjo, 5 April 2015.
- 22 Feroz Ahmed, *Ethnicity and Politics in Pakistan* (Karachi: Oxford University Press, 1998), 177
- 23 Ian Talbot, "The Punjabization of Pakistan: Myth or Reality?" In Christophe Jaffrelot (ed.), *Pakistan: Nationalism without a Nation?* (New Delhi: Manohar, 2002), 51–63.
- 24 Muhammad Waseem, "Federalism in Pakistan," Forum of Federations, August 2010, 12.
- 25 Rafiullah Kakar, "Why Political Parties Don't Care about Balochistan," *Daily Times*, 4 July 2017.
- 26 Kaiser Bengali, *A Cry for Justice: Empirical Insights from Balochistan* (Karachi: Oxford University Press, 2018), 1.
- 27 Ibid., 3.
- 28 Ibid., 7.
- 29 Ibid., 9.
- 30 Peer Muhammad, "Saindak Copper-Gold Project: Govt Moves to Transfer Ownership to Balochistan." *Express Tribune*, 27 October 2013.
- 31 "Saindak Copper and Gold Project: Centre Refuses to Hand Over Ownership Till 2018." *Express Tribune*, 24 November 2014.

- 32 "Chinese Firm Running Saindak Project Says It Paid \$ 39.8m to Balochistan Govt." *Dawn*, 14 June 2013.
- 33 Fawad Yousafzai, "Saindak Copper Gold Project: Federal Govt Likely to Transfer Project to Balochistan." *Nation*, 29 August 2017.
- 34 Saleem Shahid, "Saindak Project Leased Out to Chinese Firm for Third Time." *Dawn*, 3 October 2017.
- 35 Khurram Hussain, "Balochistan Cabinet Shocked by CPEC Presentation." *Dawn*, 11 December 2018.
- 36 Rafiullah Kakar, "No Progress Made on Balochistan Component of CPEC's Western Route." *Dawn*, 15 December 2018.
- 37 Syed Ali Shah, "Balochistan Assembly Adopts Resolution against Meagre Provincial Share in CPEC." *Dawn*, 21 December 2018.
- 38 Personal Interview, Hasil Bizenjo, 5 April 2015. And Personal Interview, Dr Abdul Malik Baloch (Chief Minister, Balochistan), 18 March 2015.
- 39 Sanaullah Baloch, "Another Kalabagh?" *News*, 9 January 2016.
- 40 "7th NFC Award Signed in Gwadar." *Dawn*, 31 December 2009.
- 41 Muhammad Sabir, "Agenda for the 8th NFC: Lessons from the 7th NFC Award, post-7th NFC Developments and Emerging Issues." *Social Policy and Development Centre*, Policy Paper No. 25, December 2014.
- 42 Janmahmad, *Essays on Baloch National Struggle in Pakistan: Emergence, Dimensions, Repercussions* (Quetta: Gosha-e-Adab, 1989), 291–93.
- 43 Paul Titus and Nina Swindler, "Knights, Not Pawns: Ethno-Nationalism and Regional Dynamics in Post-Colonial Balochistan." *International Journal of Middle East Studies* 32, no.1 (2001): 58–59.
- 44 British Balochistan was constituted in 1887 by the British when the Afghan territories occupied during the second Anglo-Afghan War (1878–80) were merged with Marri-Bugti tribal areas and territories leased from Kalat State. For details see: Robert Bruce, *The Forward Policy and Its Results* (London: Longmans, Green and Co., 1900).
- 45 Personal Interview, Nasrullah Zayrai (Member Balochistan Assembly), 26 March 2015.
- 46 Haris Gazdar, *Balochistan Economic Report: Background Paper on Social Structures and Migration* (Karachi: Collective for Social Science Research, 2007), 14–15.
- 47 Personal Interview, Dr Abdul Malik Baloch (Chief Minister, Balochistan), 18 March 2015; Personal Interview, Nasrullah Zayrai (Member Balochistan Assembly), 26 March 2015; Personal Interview, Hasil Khan Bizenjo (Senator and President National Party), 5 April 2015.
- 48 The 2013 elections saw the highest voter turnout in Balochistan compared to the previous two elections. The turnout was 43 per cent and 41 per cent in the national and provincial assembly elections respectively ("Voter Turnout Data 2013 General Elections." Election Commission of Pakistan Website).
- 49 Personal Interview, Dr Abdul Malik Baloch (Chief Minister, Balochistan), 18 March 2015; Interview, Sardar Raza Barech (Advisor to the CM Balochistan for Education), 9 April 2015.
- 50 Suhail Warraich, "The Bajwa Doctrine: From Chauvinism to Realism." *News*, 18 March 2018.
- 51 Rafiullah Kakar, "Balochistan Crisis: Lessons for PML-N." *Express Tribune*, 11 January 2018.
- 52 Nancy Ginna Bermeo, "The Import of Institutions." *Journal of Democracy* 13, no. 2 (2002): 96–110.
- 53 Nearly every single party from Balochistan demanded increase in powers of senate during the negotiations of the 18th amendment constitutional package. For details, see notes of reiteration submitted by political parties: 18th Constitutional Amendment Bill 2010 Report 2010, National Assembly of Pakistan Website (Retrieved on 15 April 2015).
- 54 Personal Interview, Naseebullah Khan Bazai (Additional Chief Secretary Planning and Development Department), Balochistan, 9 April 2015.